

MT8002 Elements of Set Theory
The Zermelo–Fraenkel Axioms
Axioms 7 to 9

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Preliminaries

Textbook

Derek Goldrei (1996). Classic Set Theory. A Guided Independent Study.

Conventions

The numbers and page numbers assigned to chapters, examples, exercises, figures, quotes, sections and theorems on these slides correspond to the numbers assigned in the textbook.

See the appendix in the course homepage for the logical symbols, mathematical symbols and acronyms not defined in these slides.

Outline

Introduction

The Axiom of Infinite

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

The Axiom of Replacement

The Axiom of Foundation

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Introduction

Formal language

Recall that in ZFC the concepts of **pure set** and **membership relation** are primitive (undefined). Also recall that the **universe of discourse** of the theory is the **pure sets**.

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Recall that in ZFC the concepts of **pure set** and **membership relation** are primitive (undefined). Also recall that the **universe of discourse** of the theory is the **pure sets**.

Classification

- Axioms stating the existence of sets
- Axioms determining properties of sets
- Axioms for building sets from other sets

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The Axiom of Infinite

Axiom of Infinite

$$\exists x (\emptyset \in x \wedge \forall y (y \in x \rightarrow y \cup \{y\} \in x)).$$

The Axiom of Infinite

Axiom of Infinite

$\exists x (\emptyset \in x \wedge \forall y (y \in x \rightarrow y \cup \{y\} \in x)).$

Informal description

“There is an inductive set.” (p. 92)

Category

Axiom stating the existence of set.

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The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

Defining the natural numbers

For defining the natural numbers in ZFC we need to define zero and successor following the Dedekind–Peano axioms.

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

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For defining the natural numbers in ZFC we need to define zero and successor following the Dedekind–Peano axioms.

Definition

A **numeral** n is the representation of a natural number n in a formal system.

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

Definition (p. 38)

0 := $\emptyset$.

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$\mathbf{0} := \emptyset$.

Definition (p. 38)

Let x be a set. The **successor** of x , denoted x^+ , is defined by

$$x^+ := x \cup \{x\}.$$

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

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Exercise 4.21

Let x be a set. Show that x^+ is also a set.

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

Example

Some numerals.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{0} &:= \emptyset, \\ \mathbf{1} &:= \mathbf{0}^+ \doteq \emptyset^+ \doteq \emptyset \cup \{\emptyset\} \doteq \{\emptyset\}, \\ \mathbf{2} &:= \mathbf{1}^+ \doteq \emptyset^{++} \doteq (\emptyset^+)^+ \doteq \{\emptyset\} \cup \{\{\emptyset\}\} \doteq \{\emptyset, \{\emptyset\}\}, \\ \mathbf{3} &:= \mathbf{2}^+ \doteq \emptyset^{++} \doteq (\emptyset^{++})^+ \doteq \{\emptyset, \{\emptyset\}\} \cup \{\{\emptyset, \{\emptyset\}\}\} \doteq \{\emptyset, \{\emptyset\}, \{\emptyset, \{\emptyset\}\}\}. \end{aligned}$$

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

Definition (p. 39)

A set y is **inductive** if

- (i) $\emptyset \in y$ and
- (ii) if $x \in y$ then $x^+ \in y$.

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

Definition (p. 39)

A set y is **inductive** if

- (i) $\emptyset \in y$ and
- (ii) if $x \in y$ then $x^+ \in y$.

Or, equivalently,

$$\frac{}{\emptyset \in y,}$$

$$\frac{x \in y}{x^+ \in y.}$$

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

Definition (p. 40)

The **set of natural numbers**, denoted $\mathbb{N}$, is the intersection of all inductive subsets of any inductive set y , that is,

$\mathbb{N} := \bigcap \{z : z \text{ is an inductive subset of } y\},$ Wrong! (Naive Comprehension Principle),
Right! (Axiom of Infinite),

$\mathbb{N} := \bigcap \{z \in \mathcal{P}(y) : z \text{ is inductive}\},$ Right! (Axiom of Separation).
Right! (Axiom of Infinite).

The Construction of the Set of the Natural Numbers

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Definition (p. 40)

A **natural number** is a member of $\mathbb{N}$.

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The Axiom of Replacement

Axiom of Replacement

$$\forall x \exists y \forall y' (y' \in y \leftrightarrow \exists x' (x' \in x \wedge \phi(x', y'))),$$

where $\phi(s, t)$ is a formula (possibly referring to named sets (possibly with parameters)) such that $\forall s \exists t (\phi(s, t) \wedge \forall t' (\phi(s, t') \rightarrow t' \doteq t))$.

The Axiom of Replacement

Axiom of Replacement

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where $\phi(s, t)$ is a formula (possibly referring to named sets (possibly with parameters)) such that $\forall s \exists t (\phi(s, t) \wedge \forall t' (\phi(s, t') \rightarrow t' \doteq t))$.

Informal description

*"If $\phi(s, t)$ is a **class** function, then when its domain is restricted to [a set] x , the resulting images form a set y ." (p. 92)*

Category

Axiom for building a set from other set.

The Axiom of Replacement

Example

From a formula (class function) $\phi(s, t)$ we can define a proper class.

The Axiom of Replacement

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For example, let $\phi(s, t): s \doteq t$ be a formula (class function). From $\phi(s, t)$ we can define the proper class

$$\mathcal{A} := \{ \langle s, s \rangle : s \text{ is a set and } \phi(s, s) \text{ holds} \}.$$

The Axiom of Replacement

Example

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For example, let $\phi(s, t): s \doteq t$ be a formula (class function). From $\phi(s, t)$ we can define the proper class

$$\mathcal{A} := \{ \langle s, s \rangle : s \text{ is a set and } \phi(s, s) \text{ holds} \}.$$

Note that $\mathcal{A}$ is a proper class because the universe of sets $\mathcal{V}$ is the proper class of first coordinates of the ordered pairs it contains.

The Axiom of Replacement

Exercise 4.23

Let x be a set. Show that $\{\{y\} : y \in x\}$ is a set.

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Solution

Let $\phi(s, t) : t \doteq \{s\}$ be a formula (class function).

By the Axiom of Replacement when the formula (class function) $\phi(s, t)$ is restricted to the set x there is a set formed with the images of the class function, that is, $\{\{y\} : y \in x\}$ is a set.

The Axiom of Replacement

Remark

Without the Axiom of Replacement we could not prove the existence of the set

$$\{\mathbb{N}, \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{N}), \mathcal{P}(\mathcal{P}(\mathbb{N})), \mathcal{P}(\mathcal{P}(\mathcal{P}(\mathbb{N}))), \dots\}.$$

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The Axiom of Foundation

Axiom of Foundation

$$\forall x \exists y (y \in x \wedge x \cap y \doteq \emptyset).$$

The Axiom of Foundation

Axiom of Foundation

$$\forall x \exists y (y \in x \wedge x \cap y \doteq \emptyset).$$

Category

Axiom determining a property of sets.

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